# Nico Rubino

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## SUMMARY

Accounting student (B.S., Western Governors University — 27 competency units remaining) with four years of financial operations in a medical practice: payer appeals, prior authorization, controlled-substance compliance, and records management, plus the Python tooling built to remove the manual work from each. Seeking accounting, audit, or financial-operations work in Tampa Bay.

## EXPERIENCE

**Practice Operations & Technology Associate** 2024 — Present
*NEXGEN Hyperbarics — Naples, FL*

- Draft clinical justification narratives and formal insurance appeal letters citing payer policy-level evidence, producing overturned adverse determinations on appealed denials.
- Manage prior authorization workflows for chronic migraine therapeutics across commercial and Medicare Advantage payers, confirming patients meet payer-specific coverage criteria before submission.
- Enforce federal DEA controlled-substance compliance: confirm urine drug screening precedes prescribing, maintain result documentation, and verify physician adherence to federal prescribing guidelines.
- Built a Python OCR-to-classification-to-routing pipeline integrating the AthenaOne REST API, CoverMyMeds ePA webhooks, and fax ingestion, replacing manual document triage; architecture enforces PHI boundaries at the routing layer.
- Maintain confidential records under HIPAA for legal requests and payer audits; assemble screening results as supporting evidence in authorization and appeal packages.

**Chef de Partie — Prepared Foods (Pizza & Chef's Case)** 2022 — 2024
*Whole Foods Market — Naples, FL*

- Executed high-volume production in a USDA/FDA-regulated kitchen; maintained HACCP compliance, cold-chain integrity, and portion-cost controls.
- Supervised and trained 3–5 team members per shift on food-safety protocols and station workflow.

## EDUCATION

**Western Governors University** — B.S. Accounting, in progress (27 competency units remaining)

Coursework: financial accounting, managerial accounting, federal taxation, business law, corporate finance, accounting information systems, auditing. CPA 150-credit pathway planned after the B.S.

## ANALYTICAL & TECHNICAL PROJECTS

**Systematic Research Framework** — Python framework for strategy development: multi-asset data ingestion, signal computation, and walk-forward validation with embargo periods and sequential kill gates. Documentation is version-controlled and includes post-mortems on methods that failed their own measurement gates.

**Healthcare Document Automation** — OCR-to-classification-to-routing pipeline integrating the AthenaOne REST API, CoverMyMeds ePA webhooks, and fax ingestion; replaced manual triage in a live practice with PHI boundary enforcement at the routing layer.

**Personal Knowledge & Retrieval Architecture** — Hybrid retrieval over a 10,000+ document corpus: FTS5 keyword search for exact terms plus a semantic layer for conceptual queries, with per-corpus index isolation and a navigation protocol across roughly 75 project records.

## SKILLS

**Payer & Claims:** insurance appeals · denial management · prior authorization · step therapy verification · payer policy analysis · coverage criteria review

**Compliance & Records:** DEA controlled-substance compliance · HIPAA · records management · audit support

**Programming & Data:** Python (NumPy, Pandas) · SQL · JavaScript · Git · REST API integration · OCR pipelines · Excel

**Accounting:** journal entries · reconciliation · month-end close support · GAAP fundamentals · QuickBooks

## CERTIFICATIONS & LEADERSHIP

QuickBooks ProAdvisor (in progress) · Google IT Support Professional Certificate (2021)

Assistant Scoutmaster, Troop 165 — youth leadership development, expedition planning, merit badge instruction.